Word problems: a calm plan

QUICK REFERENCE | Suggested grades 1-6 | Math

You do not have to solve it all at once. Start with what you know.

1. Read and tell the story

Read once. Say what is happening in your own words.

Circle the question. What are you trying to find?

2. Find the useful information

Label each amount. Cross out information you do not need.

Draw objects, a bar model, a table, or a number line.

3. Choose a plan

Are amounts joining, separating, being compared, or forming equal groups?

Write an equation. Do not choose an operation from one keyword alone.

4. Solve one step at a time

Show your work. Use a chart or a familiar fact if you need one.

5. Check and label

Does your answer fit the story? Check with a drawing or another method.

Write a sentence with the correct unit.

Example

Mia has 3 bags with 4 shells in each. She gives away 2 shells.

3 x 4 = 12 shells. 12 - 2 = 10 shells. Mia has 10 shells left.

OPP